

Sacred Heart Westmead



Information for Parents and Carers
2025

Welcome!



Welcome to the new school year. We are privileged to be partnering with you as we work towards supporting the spiritual, academic, social, physical, emotional and creative development of your child/ren.

The positive relationships developed between home, school and parish are vital for success and I am excited about the many opportunities we will have for parents to work in partnership with our Sacred Heart staff.

I feel extremely lucky to be leading such a wonderful community and look forward to the year ahead as 'Together we Grow and Rejoice'.

Mrs Mifsud
Principal



Sacred Heart's Purpose Statement



Together

WE GROW AND REJOICE

We come **TOGETHER**
as a Catholic faith community.
We give and receive respect
by living the Mercy values.

We **GROW** as learners.
We foster a positive learning
environment where individuals
are challenged and nurtured.

We **REJOICE** as one.
We celebrate our achievements
and the achievements of others.



Liturgy, Celebration and Outreach

We ensure that students come to know Jesus Christ through the promotion of Catholic tradition and teaching.

Faith experiences are woven throughout the life of the school and school values, and are realised within the Religious Education program, and through liturgy, prayer, reflection, and social justice activities to reach out to those most in need.

The school has a strong relationship with the local parish. This includes coming together for special celebrations and to support students to grow in faith. In partnership with our parish, there are many chances to attend Mass. Sacraments are facilitated through the parish and supported by the school.



Liturgy, Celebration and Outreach

Mercy Values

At Sacred Heart we have a focus on seven Mercy Values that the students, staff and parents in our school are encouraged to display.

Hospitality	Excellence	Compassion	Justice	Stewardship	Dignity	Sevice
Welcoming everyone by sharing warmth, kindness and courtesy.	Doing the absolute best that they can.	Showing kindness and understanding towards people who are feeling sad or upset.	Treating all people fairly and equally.	Using their God-given gifts to help others and look after the world.	Treating other with respect and making sure that each person feels important	Looking for ways to help others

Upcoming Community Events



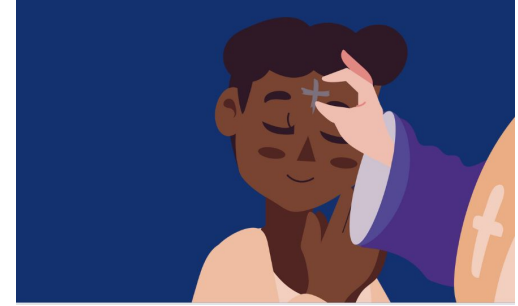
Welcome Picnic

- Friday, 28th February
- All welcome
- 6:00 - 8:00 pm
- Details to follow



Swimming Carnival

- Tuesday, 18th February
- Year 2-6 attending



Ash Wednesday Mass

- Wednesday, 5th March,
- All welcome in the church
- 9:00 am

Upcoming Community Events



Opening School Mass

- Monday, 10th February
- All welcome in the church
- 9.00am



Kindy Kids Club

- Wednesday 19th February
- Kindergarten children, along with their parents & carers are invited to a social afternoon tea
- 3:15-4:00 pm



Catholic Schools Week

- 3rd- 7th March
- Activities and events will be communicated in coming weeks

Get Involved!



At Sacred Heart we believe that effective partnerships between home and school are an important factor in a child's success. All efforts are made by the school to encourage parents to maintain a real presence as partners in a shared mission of Catholic Education. Please join us for:

- Parish Masses, School Masses and Liturgies (dates advertised throughout the term)
- Whole School Assemblies (2.50pm every Monday afternoon, and 2.30pm on Fridays in Week 4 and Week 8)
- Parent Workshops (e.g. Mathematics, English, Religion)
- Community Connections Meetings (held once per term)
- Celebration of Learning (held once per term)
- Meetings with teachers (e.g. Goal Setting meetings, Parent/Teacher/Student Conferences)
- School Fun Days, Celebrations and Social Events (e.g. the Easter Hat parade, Book Week, Picnics)
- Volunteer to help in the canteen at lunch
- Volunteer to wrap Easter egg baskets for Cabrini or to wrap gifts for Mother's Day and Father's Day
- Volunteer to assist with coaching and managing teams at gala days
- Volunteer to help at carnivals and whole school events
- Make suggestions about ideas and initiatives (perhaps you have a hidden talent or a useful skill that you'd be willing to share- e.g. Can you play an instrument? Sew? Coach a sport? Teach a skill?)

Celebrating as a Community



Birthdays

- At Sacred Heart we acknowledge and celebrate student birthdays by inviting them to wear mufti. In this way we can clearly see which students are celebrating their special day and be sure to acknowledge them with a birthday greeting.
- students are invited to wear mufti on their birthday day only. The exception to this is when their birthday falls on the weekend or during the holidays. At these times students are invited to wear mufti on either the last school day immediately preceding or immediately following their birthday. Students should not choose the day they wear mufti simply according to preference. It defeats our purpose if students are wearing mufti several days before or after their birthday as we miss the opportunity to acknowledge them in a timely manner.

Celebrating as a Community

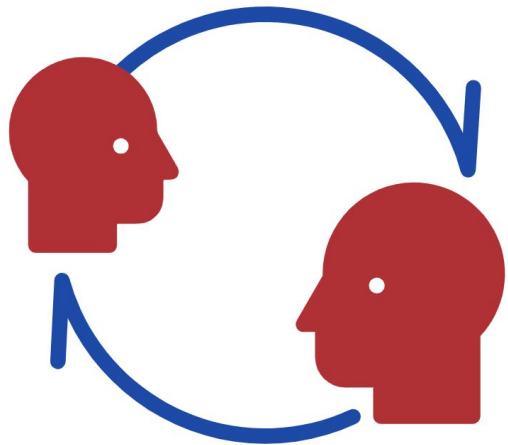


Personal Achievements and Special News

- Please contact the office via phone or email to share special news with the school community. We would love to hear about any personal achievements, sporting achievements as well as news about your family (e.g. when a baby brother or sister is born). If there is something that is important to you, or if your child is excited about something please let us know so that we can celebrate and share the special times and achievements with you.
- Equally, if your family would like prayers or if you require additional support, please let us know.

Communication

If you have any concerns about your child, an appointment should be made with your child's teacher at a mutually convenient time. Appointments can be made through the Sacred Heart school office either by phone on 8633 4500 or by email at sacredheartwestmead@parra.catholic.edu.au



If a staff member has shared their email address with you or the grade then you are welcome to email them directly during business hours (8.00am - 5.00pm). In all other instances emails should be sent to the school office to be forwarded to the relevant staff member/s by the school admin staff. Please be aware that staff may not be in a position to respond immediately, however, they will ensure that they make contact within 24hrs.

For any matters of concern, contact should be made with the classroom teacher before addressing the matter with a member of the Leadership Team if needed.

Attendance

Every day of attendance adds to a student's opportunity to learn, develop and experience success in education.

Arriving at school and class on time:

- ensures that students do not miss out on important learning activities scheduled early in the day
- helps students learn the importance of punctuality and routine
- gives students time to greet their friends before class
- reduces classroom disruption.

Lateness is recorded as a partial absence and must be explained by parents.

MON TUE WED THU FRI

every learner every day ✓

ABSENCES ADD UP!

FEBRUARY
2 DAYS
A MONTH

NOVEMBER
4 WEEKS
A YEAR

MISSING MORE THAN
1 YEAR OF
LEARNING IN **12** YEARS

DID YOU KNOW

1 IN 6
PRIMARY STUDENTS ARE NOT
ATTENDING SCHOOL REGULARLY!

EACH DAY MISSED:

- Puts your child behind and makes it harder for them to catch up
- Can lead to lower achievement in reading, writing and numeracy
- Can lead to gaps in learning and social connections

WHAT PARENTS CAN DO

- ✓ **BE FIRM.** Send your child to school every day unless they
- ✓ Develop good sleep and morning routines
- ✓ Schedule appointments after school
- ✓ Avoid taking holidays during term time

GOOD HABITS BEGIN EARLY

Good attendance starts in Kindergarten and sets students up for success in their school life

SCHOOLS ARE THERE TO HELP

If you're having attendance issues with your child, speak to your school about ways to address it.

Uniforms

School uniform is worn Monday & Friday. Sports Uniform is worn Tuesday, Wednesday & Thursday. Students are to wear full school or full sports uniform on the allocated days, not a combination of both. We ask for your cooperation in ensuring Sacred Heart's uniform expectations are met by all students each day. Please see the parent handbook for details. In particular, please ensure that your child;



- wears black school shoes (not black joggers) with their school uniform.
- wears the correct socks- navy stripe school socks or white custom sport school socks. **Ankle socks are not permitted.**
- wears the school branded legionnaires hat - in accordance with the school “No Hat No Play” Policy, **school hats must be worn whenever students are outside.**
- **wears their hair tied back if shoulder length or longer-** hair ties and accessories must be blue or black
- **wears limited jewellery** including one pair of stud or sleeper earrings per earlobe and one religious symbol (necklace or bracelet) is permitted- no other bangles, rings, bracelets or necklaces etc are permitted. Your child is welcome to wear a watch, however, **smart watches are not permitted. If your child has a smart watch or a phone it must be handed into the front office.**

Morning and Afternoon Dismissal

Students are supervised on the playground in the morning from 8:25 am. For their safety, students should not be dropped off before this time. *Parents and Carers are not permitted on the playground in the morning.* Our top priority is the safety of every child in our care. Limiting access to the playground helps us ensure that proper supervision is in place and reduces the risk of unauthorised individuals entering the premises.

At 3:00pm students are walked to playground for a 3:10pm dismissal. There are three collection points.

1. **Parents and carers can walk onto the playground when the gates are unlocked at 3:00 pm.** Parents and Carers are asked to wait on the church verandah (3-6) or asphalt behind the white line (K- 2) until the children are dismissed at 3:10 pm. Please leave via the bottom gate to avoid congestion.
2. **The bottom gate is the collection point for parents and carers who walk or park their car.** Children will be called over the microphone. They will walk down the internal path to meet their parent or carer the bottom gate at 3:10 pm.
3. **The top gate is for car pick up only.** Parents and Carers are asked to remain in their cars to ensure car pick up runs efficiently. For safety, children are to enter the car kerb side when the supervising teacher dismisses them at 3:10 pm.

Students are not permitted to exit the school grounds without a parent or guardian unless prior arrangements have been made.

Before and After School Care

Ms Manju



Opening Hours

Before & After School Care

Monday to Friday:

7.00am – 9.00am,

3.00pm – 6.30pm

Pupil Free Days

7.00am – 6.30pm

0418 280 811



Contact Us

If you have any questions, please feel free to contact the school office between 8:30 am and 3:30 pm (Monday, Wednesday, Thursday and Friday) and between 9:00 am and 3:30 pm (Tuesday).

Mrs Ward

Mrs Esposito



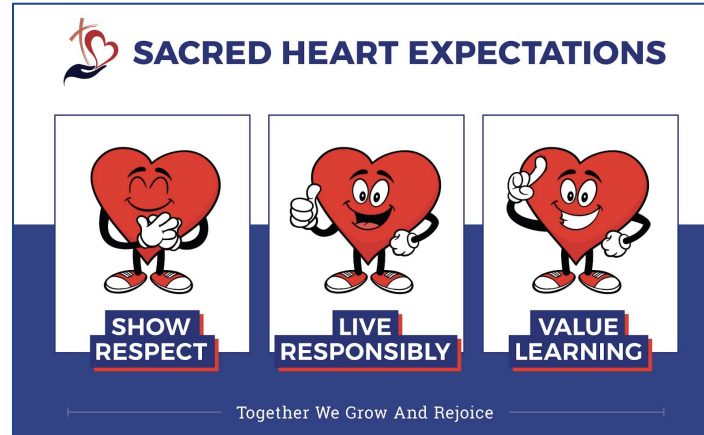
Phone: 02 8633 4500

Email: sacredheartwestmead@parra.catholic.edu.au

Positive Behaviour at Sacred Heart

Positive behaviour is important to support to enhance respectful relationships and engagement of students in their learning.

- It involves explicit teaching & learning
- It is embedded through school wide systems & practices
- It supports academic, emotional and social outcomes
- It applies to all students and all staff in all settings



Established Expectations

The expected and appropriate behaviours at Sacred Heart



At Sacred Heart I...



Show Respect	Live Responsibly	Value Learning
- speak politely and use manners - listen actively - care for others when we see a need - value individual uniqueness	- moving safely - keep my hands and feet to myself - keep all school environments clean - look after all belongings and equipment - right place, right time	- follow instructions - work collaboratively with others - problem solver - strive towards achieving our goals

	Grass Area	Hall	COLA/Undercroft	Toilet	Canteen	Cyber
Show Respect	-play fairly -invite and include others	-share the equipment	-show good sportsmanship -sit quietly in our designated area while eating	- allow privacy	- line up and wait your turn	- care for school and other people's property -access my own docs,files and those shared with me -follow copyright laws - have permission to use photographs of others
Live Responsibly	- wear school hat - stay in bounds - taking turns	- return/pack away equipment	- wear school hat	- use, flush, wash and leave -use toilet paper correctly	- follow the canteen procedures	- keep passwords safe - use ICT and social media appropriately - report all unsafe or inappropriate content
Value Learning	-play by the rules of the game	-cooperate with others -take turns	-play by the rules of the game	-use during break times	- line up according to infants and primary	-use devices and sites for learning -stay focussed on technology tasks

Student Management Flowchart

Used to guide staff responses and decision making process in addressing inappropriate behaviour.

Pulls together practices/strategies for responding to inappropriate behaviours.

Includes a continuum of responses, when, where and how to document incident for data decision making, problem solving.

Sacred Heart, Westmead Behaviour Response/Decision Making Flowchart					
Response to ALL student inappropriate behaviour is:					
1. Calm	2. Consistent	3. Brief	4. Immediate	5. Respectful	
Utilise Proactive Strategies					
EXPECTATIONS Display & refer to expectations Use language of expectations & matrix Regular PBS4L lessons Acknowledge behaviours	ORGANISATION Learning space clutter free Seating plan Visual timetable Established routines Access to shared resources Prepared for teaching/duty	ACTIONS Build positive relationships & climate Active Supervision Short directions Firm and Positive Continuum of responses	REINFORCEMENT Verbal Praise Specific Feedback Public Acknowledgment Token Reward (5:1 ratio)		
Minor Teacher Managed			Major Leadership Managed		
Hands on/Physical Behaviours - Pushing, shoving, lashing out Inappropriate language - Non directed (accidental) - Directed (low level) Non-compliance - Not following direction/instruction, request (reasonable time) Academic Learning Behaviour - unsatisfactory work completion, incomplete work/assignment Inappropriate use of Property/ Equipment/ Environment - Misuse - Incorrect use Cyber/Technology - Incorrect site, or use of device			Hands on/Physical Behaviours - Physical aggression that has wilful intent to hurt/harm - Delivered with intensity and severity Inappropriate language - Racial, discriminatory - Direct at another person or situation Non Compliance - Defiance after repeated request Inappropriate use of equipment/property - Purposeful or wilful intent Harassment/Intimidation - disrespectful messages that include threats or intimidation Bullying - intentional/deliberate/ongoing/repeated/sustained Cyber/Technology - Inappropriate site Prohibited Items/Illegal/Reportable Repeated minor teacher managed behaviours (see Step 3)		
Continuum of Responses (see student flowchart) Indirect Response - Praise appropriate behaviour in others - Physical Proximity - Gesture/Non-verbal Cue Direct Response - Re-direct - Re-teach - Provide Choice - Conference with Student (in private) Logical Consequence (see options) - Document on Sacred Heart Slip (playground) - Document preferred method (classroom)			Offer Calm Space  Behaviour Improves, Provide Positive Feedback	Major behaviours or repeated minor teacher managed behaviours will be escalated to the AP or Principal - where safety is not a concern use an email or Chronicle notification chain - serious behaviours can be directly referred to AP or Principal - call for immediate assistance - in the event that the AP or Principal are unavailable, seek assistance from the REC or a Coordinator - in the event that the REC or a Coordinator are unavailable, seek support from another teacher off class if immediate assistance is required in a serious situation <i>*Please note, it is not school practice to send students to other classes or the office for timeout</i>	
Data Response Rule: 3-5 playground or classroom slip/week (repeated behaviour) or 5+/term (various behaviours) - Document Chronicle (amber) - Use notification chain to inform AP/PP/ Teacher - Contact parent/carer (call)				Assist Principal/Principal: Investigation - Meet with involved student/s, hear all voices and establish facts/details, possibly use reflection sheet - Review any previous documentation (for repeated behaviour) and - Assess the seriousness of the incident Decision Making - Consequences Communicate - Speak with those involved, phone parent (if required), respect the dignity and privacy of all involved Follow Up - Check in with student/s involved sometime after incident (if required) <i>* Please note, in alignment with the Procedural Fairness Guidelines, the Principal and their delegates have the authority to interview students without a parent or carer present or being notified in advance. During this process there will be times where a student/s is/are removed from the learning space or playground, parental permission is not required. If necessary parents will be informed.</i>	
Minor Behaviours Continue: 2-3 Amber Chronicles - Informal case conference with a member of leadership - Develop and implement school based intervention					
Behaviour Continues: 4-5 Chronicles - Refer to a member of leadership					
<i>Please note, individual behaviour plans take precedence over these procedures.</i>					
Logical Consequences (CLASSROOM/ PLAYGROUND): - Forced choice e.g. the alternative, less desirable choice - Logical consequence linked to inappropriate behaviour e.g. break - If fix it, unfinished - finish it, messed it - clean it - Restorative practices e.g. Aact of apology / act of restitution - Review of expectations, guidelines, policy - Environmental change e.g. change seat, group, activity, equipment, resources, game, playground area - Thinking time/temporary removal (time out, sit out of play)					

Learning

Curriculum Overviews

- Curriculum Overviews for each stage are shared on Compass at the beginning of each term.
- Curriculum Overviews provide information about the outcome, topics and units of work that will be studied during that term for each Key Learning Area.

Home Learning

- Homework is a purposeful extension of student learning. It provides opportunities for parents to be involved in the ongoing education of their child.
- Information about how to access and complete Home Learning tasks will be shared on Compass at the start of each term in preparation for the first cycle of Home Learning, which will commence in week 2 of each term (Week 3 in term 1, 2025).
- New Home Learning tasks will be shared on Google classroom each fortnight.

Creative Arts

Mrs Iuliano

Each week the students participate in two 60 minute Creative Arts lessons where they will explore Dance, Drama, Music and Visual Arts.

Welcome to Creative Arts.

I am very excited for the year ahead and all the exciting things that the students will experience. The students will develop essential knowledge and skills that are central to developing understanding and practices in all aspects of the Creative Arts. They will be composing, performing, appreciating, creating and making. I am passionate about Creative Arts and it brings me great joy to see the excitement on the students' faces when their creations come to life.



Kindergarten

Ms Hu

Welcome to Kindergarten 2025!

I firmly believe that all students are capable, creative and resourceful.

My goal as a teacher is to inspire learning success for all students by nurturing growth mindsets, providing a safe and conducive learning environment and building strong, collaborative relationships with parents and carers.

I look forward to working with your child, and hope their journey is a positive and productive one.



Year 1

Mrs Shomar

Welcome to Year 1!

I am so excited to share this year with you all! Your child will learn, grow and be filled with joy as they journey through the year.

I am committed to help your child flourish in their faith journey as children of God.

The motto in Year 1 is, “everyone is on their own learning journey”. I believe every child has their own unique talents and strengths and my goal is to foster a welcoming and inclusive environment.



Year 2

Miss Matienzo (Mon-Wed)

Mrs Sharma (Thur-Fri)



A warm welcome to the Year 2 journey!

It is a privilege to partner with you in nurturing your child during this stage of their growth and learning.

In Year 2, we have a commitment to creating a supportive, open and safe environment, where Jesus remains at the centre and where the Mercy Values guide all that we do.

This year, we aim to deepen your child's sense of curiosity, faith and love for learning whilst encouraging them to flourish in all aspects of their being.

Together, as partners in their education, we look forward to a year full of growth, joy and shared achievements.

Year 2 is a place where we all bloom and grow!

God bless!

Miss Matienzo and Mrs Sharma

Year 3

Miss Cordell

Welcome to Year 3!

I am so excited to work with your children this year. A quick known fact about me, I have wanted to be a Primary School Teacher since I was in Year Two and have never changed my mind.

I am very passionate about all students having a positive attitude towards their learning. I also like to remind students' that if they have a positive attitude towards their learning they will receive a positive result. I believe that all students learn differently and I will work to ensure that each person supported and challenged appropriately.

My goal as a teacher is to make learning fun across all Key learning areas while supporting the students to follow our Sacred Heart expectations to Show Respect, Live Responsibly and Value Learning.

It's my pleasure that I will get to work with your children this year.



Year 4

Mr Southwell-Keely

Welcome to Year 4!

In our stage, class and school we value each and every student for who they are. For it is said that we are all created in God's image.

In Year 4, I encourage all students to be themselves, holistically, to continue to grow and develop in to young boys and girls living out their faith.

I am sure that 2025 will be a great year to further your child's enthusiasm and enjoyment for learning.

I look forward to meeting with you at our goal setting meetings shortly and working with you throughout the year.



Year 5

Miss Haddad

Welcome to Year 5!

Year 5 is filled with fun, collaborative and exciting learning experiences.

We prioritise respect for each other, our work and our space. We encourage all students to approach each opportunity with determination and curiosity.

The Keys to Success in Year 5 are; Confidence, Persistence, and Resilience. All students are encouraged to adopt and develop these traits in all that they do, ensuring optimal productivity and performance.

We draw strength from Philippians 4:13, "I can do all things through Christ who strengthens me Philippians 4:13".



Year 6

Mrs Moshtaghi (Mon-Thur)

Miss Bassil (Fri)

Welcome to Year 6!

Your child's final year. As we are aware, this is a milestone year for your child, we will strive to create lasting memories and instil in them the school's expectations, values and life lessons.

We are dedicated to creating a safe, warm and welcoming environment that caters to the needs of your child in a positive and effective way. We hope to equip them with the skills and necessities to prepare them for high school.

*Our classroom is founded upon the notion of "Love one another, as I have loved you"
(John 13:34)*



Diversity Support

Mrs Kfourri, Mrs Galea, Mrs Smith, Mrs Sultana & Mrs Doan Tran

As a Diversity team we work with classroom teachers to foster an inclusive and equitable learning environment for all students. We celebrate and respect the learning journey of each individual. Our aim is to enrich their academic journey and prepare them to become thoughtful, compassionate people in the world we live in. Parents play a crucial role in this effort and we look forward to partnering with you.



Teachers Aides

Miss Danielle, Miss Jen & Miss Emily

As Sacred Heart Primary School teacher aides, we take pride in developing positive relationships with all staff and students to demonstrate our commitment and understanding of the Catholic School Mission.

We consider it a privilege getting to know our students as individuals and to work closely with our teachers to facilitate our students educational growth.

